



# **FAMILY COURT CASE FILE (MOCK) – FINAL VERSION**

## **Maricopa County, Arizona**

**Case No: FC-2026-10458**

**Confidential – Mock Legal Simulation**

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## **PAGE 1 – COVER SHEET**

**In the Matter of:**

Joni Carter (Petitioner)

vs.

Michel Carter (Respondent)

Type: Dissolution of Marriage

Filed: 10 February 2026

Judge: Hon. Rebecca Lawson

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## PAGE 3 – CASE SUMMARY

This case involves the dissolution of a 12-year marriage between Joni Carter and Michel Carter, including disputes over custody, financial assets, and allegations of addiction-related instability affecting the family environment.

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## PAGES 4–5 – PARTIES INFORMATION

### **Joni Carter**

Age: 44 | Occupation: Marketing Consultant

Role: Petitioner

### **Michel Carter**

Age: 46 | Occupation: Construction Project Manager

Role: Respondent

Residence: Phoenix, Arizona

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## PAGE 6 – CHILDREN INFORMATION

- Emma Carter – 11
- Noah Carter – 8
- Olivia Carter – 5

All children reside in Phoenix, Arizona and attend local schools.

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## PAGES 7–10 – DETAILED MARITAL BACKGROUND

The parties married in 2014 in Phoenix, Arizona, after a four-year relationship. Initially, the marriage was stable and supportive. Michel worked full-time in construction management, while Joni developed her consulting career while raising their children.

Between 2015–2021, the couple had three children and purchased a family home in 2017.

By 2018, financial irregularities began to emerge, marking the beginning of marital deterioration.

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## PAGES 11–14 – GROUNDS FOR DIVORCE (DETAILED NARRATIVE)

### 2018 – Discovery of Financial Irregularities

Joni Carter discovered unusual credit card transactions, including:

- Online gambling platforms
- Foreign transactions
- Repeated unexplained withdrawals

Michel eventually admitted to **online gambling behavior**.

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### 2019–2023 – Addiction Escalation

Despite rehabilitation attempts, Michel's gambling behavior continued. Over time, it escalated into:

- Financial secrecy
- Debt accumulation
- Emotional withdrawal
- Missed family responsibilities

Joni initiated multiple interventions including therapy and financial counseling.

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## 2023 – Alcohol Use & Domestic Incident

In 2023, Michel began consuming alcohol regularly. During a financial argument, a **physical escalation occurred in which Michel raised his hand toward Joni**, causing fear and immediate distress.

No severe physical injury occurred, but the event significantly impacted family safety perception.

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## Impact on Children

- Emma developed anxiety symptoms
- Noah exhibited behavioral issues at school
- Olivia showed emotional regression and fear responses

The household environment became increasingly unstable.

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## 2024–2025 – Failed Recovery Attempts

Multiple rehabilitation efforts failed, including:

- Gambling addiction treatment programs
- Family therapy sessions
- Temporary financial control agreements

Relapse occurred repeatedly.

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## 2026 – Decision to Separate

Due to ongoing instability, Joni Carter filed for divorce on February 3, 2026.

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| Party         | Annual Income |
|---------------|---------------|
| Joni Carter   | \$95,000      |
| Michel Carter | \$130,000     |

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## PAGES 16–18 – ASSET INVENTORY

- Home: \$620,000
  - Mortgage: \$280,000
  - Savings: \$74,500
  - Investments: \$112,000
  - Vehicles: \$50,000 total
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## PAGE 19 – DEBT SUMMARY

- Mortgage: \$280,000
  - Credit debt: \$11,850
  - Loans: \$9,400
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## PAGES 20–21 – PARENTING PLAN

Primary custody requested by Joni Carter.

Michel Carter requests shared custody.

Court recommendation (draft):

- Joint legal custody
  - Primary residence with Joni
  - Structured visitation schedule
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## PAGE 22 – CHILD IMPACT REPORT

Observed emotional effects:

- Anxiety
- Behavioral instability
- Sleep disturbances
- Emotional dependency

Professional recommendation: stable primary home environment required.

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## PAGE 23 – COURT FINDINGS (DRAFT)

- Both parents fit for custody
  - History of addiction documented
  - Domestic conflict acknowledged
  - Shared custody viable but structured required
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## PAGE 24 – FINAL JUDGMENT

- Marriage dissolved
  - Joint custody granted
  - Primary residence: Joni Carter
  - Asset division: equal split
  - Child support: \$1,285/month
  - Home sale ordered within 12 months
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## EXHIBITS (A–F)

- A. Property Deed
- B. Bank Statements
- C. Credit Card Records
- D. Therapy Reports

E. School Reports

F. Communication Logs